

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X: _____ RESULTS: _____

Species (please include common and scientific name): *Red 1/14/01 wpe* Tricolored Heron (*Egretta tricolor*)

Date(s) of Observation: July 20, 2000

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: unknown Plumage: adult

Exact location: South shore of Davey Lake at Russell Lakes SWA in Saguache County.

Length of observation: approx. 15 minutes

Time(s) of observation: approx 7 a.m

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you:

Doug Faulkner and I saw the bird at a nearby marsh a day later.

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): The bird was initially identified by a CDOW technician. He said that the bird had been around for nearly a month.

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position): Good light. Clear. Morning sun behind the viewer.

Optical equipment used: 10x40 binoculars. 15-60X spotting scope.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 150 feet.

Was bird(s) photographed? Yes

Have you submitted photos? No..

Who took the photographs? Myself.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: The bird was standing just inside the edge of a stand of emergent vegetation—bulrush—along the shore of Davey Lake in Russell Lakes SWA. Major colonies of Snow Egrets, White-faced Ibis, and Black-crowned Night-Herons nest here.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

The bird was standing still for most of the observation. It seemed to be aware of my presence and was pretending to be vegetation.

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Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

A heron only slightly larger than the nearby Snowy Egrets. Blue-gray, horn colored, bill. Yellowish-white around red eye. Rusty red neck with whitish line along throat broken by rusty streaks. Blue-gray pate. Brownish gray back. White belly. Grayish legs.

Describe birds call or song: None.

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Nothing remotely resembles this bird.

What is your prior experience with this and similar-appearing species? A life-list bird.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): Reviewed descriptions in National Geographic (3rd ed.) following the observation to confirm field marks recorded.

This report was made from notes made **during** the observation.

Date of written report: January 14, 2001.

Signature:

Reporting observer: Rich

Levad

Address: 564 B Villa St.

Grand Junction, CO 81504



Send report to: Colorado Birds Record Committee
c/o Bill Lisowsky 2919 Silverplume Dr. Ft. Collins, Co. 80526